



Photo shows Pip as a style reference, not the rattle itself.

LME CROCHET PATTERN - BABY

PIP'S RATTLE

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A little hedgehog rattle on a wooden ring, approx. 13 to 15 cm tall. The head is shaped like a miniature version of Pip, with soft ears, a little spike stripe down the centre, a sage green ruffled collar around the neck and a rattle capsule safely tucked inside.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the safety page once before you start. The rattle capsule must be sewn in completely and should never be removable by the child.

ABOUT PIP'S RATTLE

PART OF ELLIE'S WORLD

Pip's rattle belongs to the LME Baby Collection "Woodland Dreams". This little hedgehog head on a wooden ring is meant as the child's very first meeting with Pip, made for hands that are still too small to hold the toy itself.

STYLE

Scandinavian and Montessori-inspired, in the same natural colours as the rest of the collection: cream, dark warm brown and sage green. A round, soft shape with no sharp edges.

FUNCTION

The wooden ring gives a safe, easy-to-grip handle shape. The rattle capsule inside the head makes a soft rustling sound. The spike stripe gives a little texture to explore with small fingers.

MATERIALS AND YARN ALTERNATIVES

YARN

Bystrikk Merino, cream (main colour), dark warm brown (ears and spike stripe) and sage green (the collar), the same yarn as the rest of Pip's pattern.

Alternative yarn: any soft cotton-blend DK-weight yarn works well, for example DROPS Safran or Hobbii Amigo.

TOOLS AND SUPPLIES

- **Heklenål 3 eller 3,5 mm** · litt tettere enn Pip selv, siden hodet er lite
- **Polyesterfiber til fyll** · liten mengde
- **Trering, ca. 6 til 7 cm i diameter** · umalt, CE-merket, beregnet for barn
- **Rangleboks eller rangleinnsats** · en liten, lukket kapsel med rangleperler, beregnet for amigurumi/leketøy. Aldri løse perler eller bjeller direkte i fyllet
- **Stoppenål med butt spiss** · til all somming
- **Tvinnet bomullstråd og nål** · til å sy rangleboksen og ringen godt fast
- **Saks og målebånd**

DIFFICULTY, SIZE AND GAUGE

DIFFICULTY

Easy. A nice project if you have just learned amigurumi.

FINISHED HEIGHT

Approx. 13 to 15 cm, from the bottom of the wooden ring to the top of the ears.

GAUGE

Crochet tightly, amigurumi tension: approx. 20 sc x 22 rounds = 10 x 10 cm on a 3 mm hook. The stuffing and rattle capsule should not show through, or feel sharp through, the stitches.

ABBREVIATIONS

The whole rattle is crocheted with single crochet in a spiral, except the spike stripe, which uses the same loop technique as Pip's own spikes. Here are the abbreviations, with the common US crochet terms alongside.

Norwegian	US	Means
lm	ch	luftmaske / chain
fm	sc	fastmaske / single crochet
kjm	sl st	kjedemaske / slip stitch
løkkm	loop st	løkkemaske: se Pips egen oppskrift for full forklaring
magisk ring	magic ring	justerbar startring uten hull i midten
økn	inc	økning: 2 fm i samme maske. Gir én maske mer.
mink	dec	minking: 2 fm sammen. Gir én maske mindre.
m	st(s)	maske(r)
omg	rnd	omgang, en hel runde rundt i spiral
()	()	totalt antall masker på omgangen
...	*...*	gjenta det mellom stjernene så mange ganger som står bak

TIPS BEFORE YOU START

- Buy the rattle capsule before you start, so you know it fits inside the head before you finish crocheting.
- Stuff filling around the rattle capsule on all sides, so it cannot slide and rattle loosely inside.
- Hold the ring up against the head as you go, to check the proportions look right.

HOW THE RATTLE IS BUILT

Four pieces are crocheted separately, then sewn together around the wooden ring at the end:

1. The head

holds the rattle capsule inside

2. The neck and collar

a tube with a sage green ruffled edge, sewn around the wooden ring

3. The ears

two, soft, two layers

4. The spike stripe

a little loop-stitch stripe down the centre

SIZE

Approx. 13 to 15 cm, from the bottom of the wooden ring to the top of the ears.

PART 1: THE HEAD

The head is crocheted in a spiral, from the top down, in cream. The rattle capsule is inserted before the last rounds are closed.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30
6 to 9	30 sc, 4 rounds with no increases	30
10	(3 sc, dec) x 6 - stuff firmly from here	24
11	(2 sc, dec) x 6 - insert the rattle capsule now, well surrounded by stuffing	18
12	(1 sc, dec) x 6	12
13	dec x 6	6

Do not cut the yarn. Diameter approx. 8 cm. You use the same yarn to attach the head to the neck later.

PART 2: THE NECK AND THE WOODEN RING

The neck is a short tube that is sewn around the wooden ring and attaches the head to the handle.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3 to 5	12 sc, 3 rounds	12

Do not cut the yarn. Place the wooden ring inside the neck tube, fold the edge of the tube over the ring and sew all the way around it with tight, secure stitches, so the ring is fully enclosed and cannot slide out.

THE RUFFLED COLLAR (SAGE GREEN)

Before sewing the head on: attach sage green yarn at the top edge of the neck (12 sts). *1 sc in the next stitch, skip 1 stitch, 3 dc in the next stitch (a little fan)*, repeat all the way around the edge (6 fans in total). Fasten off and weave in the end.

ATTACH THE HEAD TO THE NECK

Sew the head onto the neck with tight stitches all the way around, centred over the ring.

PART 3: THE EARS AND THE SPIKE STRIPE

THE EARS (MAKE 2, TWO LAYERS)

Outside (dark warm brown): 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18). Fasten off. Inside (cream): 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12). Fasten off. Sew the light circle onto the middle of the dark one, and sew the ears onto the top of the head, one on each side.

THE SPIKE STRIPE

Instead of a bow, Pip's rattle gets a miniature of his signature part: chain 4 + 1 turning chain in dark warm brown, 3 rows of loop st (4 loop st each row). Cut, leaving a long tail. Sew the spike stripe on along the centre line from the forehead and backward, between the ears and down the back of the head.

THE FACE, EMBROIDERED

Embroider two round eyes in black satin stitch and a small triangular nose below. No plastic safety eyes here, since the rattle must be entirely free of hard or loose parts apart from the rattle capsule, which is safely hidden inside.

ASSEMBLY, STEP BY STEP

- 1 Crochet the head, leave it open until the rattle capsule is ready.
- 2 Stuff the head evenly, place the rattle capsule in the middle, well surrounded by stuffing on all sides, and close the last rounds.
- 3 Crochet the neck, place the wooden ring inside, and sew the tube securely around the whole ring.
- 4 Crochet the ruffled collar around the top edge of the neck, before sewing the head on.
- 5 Sew the head onto the neck, centred over the ring and the collar.
- 6 Sew the ears onto the top of the head, and the spike stripe along the centre line.
- 7 Embroider the face.
- 8 Fasten every loose end securely on the inside, and trim what is left.
- 9 Gently shake the rattle and listen: the sound should come through evenly and clearly, with nothing rattling loose.

SAFETY

THE RATTLE CAPSULE MUST NEVER COME OUT

The rattle capsule is the only hard part in this rattle, and it must be fully enclosed by yarn and stuffing, with no opening. Check thoroughly that there are no gaps or weak seams it could fall out through, either when newly made or after washing and use over time.

MORE IMPORTANT RULES

- Always use under adult supervision, especially the first few times, until you are confident every seam holds.
- No parts are glued. Everything is sewn on with strong, twisted cotton thread and plenty of tight stitches.
- Use only a wooden ring and rattle capsule that are unpainted/CE-marked and intended for children, never reused parts from adult products.
- The loop stitches in the spike stripe are soft and harmless, but should be checked regularly to make sure no loop has become so loose that a small child's finger could get caught in it.
- Check the rattle regularly for wear: loose threads, soft or uneven patches, or a rattle capsule that feels loose. Discard the rattle immediately if anything is wrong.
- This pattern is a guide for home use. If the finished product is sold, it must always be checked, tested and marked as required under current local safety requirements and regulations for children's products/toys.

CARE AND WASHING

Hand wash in lukewarm water with a little mild soap. Rinse well. Gently press out the water in a towel, do not wring. Lay flat to dry, and check that the rattle capsule has not taken on water before using the rattle again.

CONGRATULATIONS, THE RATTLE IS DONE!

Now you have crocheted a little Pip rattle. Give it a gentle shake and listen to the soft sound!

THE REST OF THE LME BABY COLLECTION

- Ellie, the little fawn
- Pip, the little hedgehog
- Felix, the little fox
- Molly, the little lamb
- Luna, the little bunny
- Oliver, the little bear
- Ellie's pacifier clip
- Pip's pacifier clip
- Felix's pacifier clip
- Molly's pacifier clip
- Luna's pacifier clip
- Oliver's pacifier clip
- Felix's rattle
- Molly's rattle
- Luna's rattle
- Oliver's rattle
- Ellie's rattle
- Ellie's stroller toy
- Ellie's ballerina shoes
- Ellie's activity toy

COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished pieces you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · lmexplorers.com